



It's in the fruit

After being pollinated, a flower produces seeds. To help seeds disperse to new habitats, many plants wrap them in a fruit. Fruits are often sweet and fleshy to attract animals, which eat the fruit and discard the seeds later in droppings.



Grasses

Grasses are flowering plants with tiny flowers that are pollinated by wind. Grasses appeared in the Cretaceous, but grasslands as we know them didn't really become established until around 10 million years ago.



Life in the cold

Flowering plants can survive in hot deserts or on freezing mountaintops. In the land around the North Pole, where the deep soil is frozen solid, trees can't survive but small flowering plants cover the ground, forming a landscape called tundra.



They are everywhere

Today, practically all we eat that isn't meat comes from a flowering plant, while farmed animals, such as cattle, depend on such plants for nourishment. Even our clothes are made from flowering plants, which are used for making linen and cotton.

▼ A COLORFUL MEADOW

Many flowering plants burst into bloom in the spring, when insect pollinators become active as the weather warms up. All the plants you can see in this picture are members of the flowering plant family.

